



christian brown

Engineering Manager
London, UK

I'm a people manager and solutions architect with a background in world-class content management systems and online video workflows, backed by a decade and a half of experience with well-known, high-traffic, enterprise-level web properties created and maintained by globally distributed teams. I'm a strong proponent of high-quality, reusable, and maintainable solutions using SOLID design principles, unit testing, and continuous integration.

current role



Senior Engineering Manager

eBay in London, UK
Aug 2022 – Now

I manage a team of 6-7 'full stack' engineers in the global shipping department, based in London with staff in Toronto and contractors in Cyprus. We are responsible for post-sales experience for sellers on the web, including revenue-sensitive shipping/postage purchasing and label generation systems. We use carrier integrators such as Pitney Bowes, Scurri, EasyShip, EasyPost & Packlink, shipping via USPS, UPS, FedEx, Royal Mail, Parcelforce, Hermes (DE), Deutsche Post, DHL, Canada Post, Australia Post, Hubbed, DPD, Yodel, and Evri (UK). We operate these services in the US, CA, UK, DE, and AU, facilitating workflows such as pay-on-print, pay-on-scan (QR code), bulk shipping, returns, cross-border exports, and ship to eBay Vault or eBay Authentication Guarantee centres.

I have transformed the team from project-feature to product-ownership driven, increased productivity & introduced velocity measurement, reduced production issues & customer reported defects by over half, and empowered engineers to think about architecture and maintainability over short term results. I also handle long-term planning / project management, staff training, performance management, redundancies, hiring, and promotions.

The engineers build microservices in React, Node.js, Marko, and Java, deployed into eBay's private cloud infrastructure using proprietary or extended open-source tools.

previous roles



Engineering Manager

Red Ventures in London, UK
Aug 2021 – Jul 2021 (1yr)

I managed the central Video engineering team of 6 back-end engineers in the US and UK, with additional contractors from South America. We built a new SaaS video ecosystem to support up to two billion unique video-on-demand (VOD) play sessions per year. We also handled live-streaming, captioning, digital asset management, ads integration, analytics, and distribution. We onboarded CNET, ZDNet, GameSpot, GiantBomb, TV Guide, OnlineMBA, Cord Cutters News, BestColleges, NurseJournal and were in the process of bringing Healthline, Metacritic and LonelyPlanet onto our platform. We worked with vendors such as AWS Elemental, Fastly, Bitmovin, Rev, and Mux. The engineers built API orchestration and microservices in Node.js (Express) & Go/Golang (Goa), CMS integrations in PHP (Symfony, WordPress), and deployed into AWS and GCP with CircleCI on infrastructure managed with Terraform.



Lead Software Engineer

Red Ventures in London, UK
Nov 2020 – Aug 2021 (10mths)

By acquisition from ViacomCBS, reporting to the VP of Engineering, I oversaw the migration of systems and workflows, including setting transition targets, undertaking vendor evaluations, and managing engineering deliverables & stakeholder expectations. I architected the replacement VOD solution based on GCP, Bitmovin and Fastly, which serves just shy of a billion video play sessions per year. Achievements include saving US\$430,000 first year and US\$275,000pa after that in costs for video content management by removing a vendor from our workflow with minimal impact on users and the business.



Lead Software Engineer

ViacomCBS / CBS Interactive in London, UK

Apr 2016 – Nov 2020 (4yrs, 7mths)

I was a team leader with direct reports, reporting to the VP of Engineering, part of a larger central CMS team of 13 engineers spread across the US, with support from product, PM, QA and DevOps. We maintained the CMS, REST APIs, and tech stack that powered web properties ViacomCBS operated internationally, including CBS News (inc. 60 Minutes), CBS Sports, 24/7 Sports, MaxPreps, SportsLine, CNET, ZDNet, TechRepublic, Download.com, TV Guide, and many more. My team were the subject-matter experts on all video-on-demand (VOD) content - interfacing with internal and third-party vendors for transcoding, storage, metadata management, captioning/transcription, ingestion, publishing, and distribution (e.g., YouTube). Achievements include saving US\$500,000pa from video playback costs, bypassing a third-party video platform, and avoiding the pay per play.



Senior Software Engineer

CBS / CBS Interactive in Singapore, then London, UK

Jan 2012 – Apr 2016 (4yrs, 4 months)

Initially based in Singapore as part of a team lead out of Sydney, we maintained a CMS that powered many of CBS Interactive's international brands. We built a new adaptive and responsive CMS user interface with just a few engineers within a couple of months for ZDNet. Out of that success, our teams merged with the US, building a CMS to power almost all of CBS' web properties, covering broadcast, news, sports, tech, gaming, and food verticals. I led the video workflow integration whilst based in San Francisco for 6 weeks.



Software Engineer / Web Developer

CNET Networks in London, UK

Sep 2007 – Jan 2012 (4yrs, 4 months)

I was part of an international team supporting localised versions of CNET and ZDNet in the UK, AU, Asia, DE and FR. We developed a Zend-based framework used by engineers in those regions to handle scalability problems such as routing, caching and CDN integration. I also provided support for GameSpot, TV.com and TechRepublic. I delivered training in the Paris office to French and German teams; and presented our achievements at our off-site in Singapore.



Associate Programmer

iiNet in Perth, Australia

Jul 2006 – Sep 2007 (1yr, 3mths)

I was part of the Customer Service Tools team within the Applications Dept., responsible for developing and maintaining internal web-based applications to manage customers and staff. We built and supported CRM, billing, HR, and B2B ordering & monitoring systems that integrated third-party telecommunication APIs to process broadband applications with upstream providers (Telstra). I was awarded 'Hardest Worker of the Year' in 2006.



Senior Customer Service Representative

iiNet in Perth, Australia

Jan 2005 – Jul 2006 (1yr, 7 months)

I was a team leader in the contact centre, assisting and coaching customer service representatives, standing in for managers for customers with escalated technical or billing issues, identifying and lodging network-wide faults with operations and liaising with high-value clients. I created a set of web-based customer service tools, including a copper wire attenuation calculator based on raw telecommunications cable data to calculate the theoretical maximum DSL speed and a scheduling/roster user interface. The tools were used by all staff across Australian, NZ and South African offices. I was awarded 'Most Innovative Staff Member' in 2005.



Freelance developer

trading as Clix Web Development in Perth, Australia

Main trading period 2001 – 2006 (6yrs)

I provided web development services for small to medium businesses, including hosting and domain name management. Based on my own CMS, I created and supported web properties from simple microsites to intranets and full shopping portals. I worked closely with clients, from concept and design to development, deployment, and support.



IT Consultant/IT Administrator

Mineral Engineering Technical Services (METS) in Perth, Australia

Jan 2002 – Dec 2004 (3yrs)

Oversaw IT operations, from desktop and server IT support to development, hosting and maintenance of their websites, intranet and other web-based tools. I also provided on-site IT support, consulting and web development for their clientele.

education



Bachelor of Computer Science (Hons)

University of Western Australia

Majored in **Electronic Business** and **IT Systems**. Dissertation “Visualising the Berkeley Sockets API”.

volunteering



NHS Volunteer Responder

Royal Voluntary Service at Science Museum Mass Vaccination Centre, London, UK

Mar 2021 – Sep 2021 (6mths), 420hrs (70x6hr shifts)